

Option P1: Spain and the 'New World', c1490–c1555

Key topic 1: Spain reaches the Americas, c1490–1512

1 Spanish exploration	- Spain c1490: the crusading spirit and foreign ambitions. - Columbus's attempts to gain sponsorship. The role of Queen Isabella: her desire to spread Christianity and sponsorship of Columbus. - Columbus's first voyage of 1492 and the problems encountered.
2 Columbus reaches the Americas	- Columbus's actions: exploration of the Bahamas and the Caribbean. The foundation of La Navidad. - The impact of contact with Indigenous peoples: the discovery of gold, relations with the Tainos and Caribs. - The impact of rivalry with Portugal, and the Treaty of Tordesillas (1494).
3 Spanish claims in the Caribbean	- Columbus's later voyages and his role as governor in the Spanish settlement. The significance of the establishment of the Spanish colony at Santo Domingo (1496). - The effects of Spanish settlement: treatment of Indigenous peoples, effects of smallpox. - Development of an imperial policy in relation to the Caribbean: the regulation of further exploration, the establishment of a monopoly on trade, the extension of Spanish authority and the use of slavery. The role of Catholic missionaries.

Key topic 2: The conquistadors, 1513–c1528

1 The start of an empire	- Balboa's claim of Spanish authority over the Pacific (1513). - The conquest of Cuba. - The voyage of Magellan and Spanish claim to the Philippines.
2 The conquest of Mexico	- Cortes's expedition to Mexico in 1519. - Key events of the Spanish conquest of Mexico; the role of Montezuma, the war between Aztecs and Tlaxcalans. - The capture of Tenochtitlan and the Aztec surrender.
3 Impact of Spain in the Americas	- Cortes's actions as Governor and Captain-General of New Spain (1523–28). - The consequences of the Spanish invasion for the Aztecs. - The founding and significance of a Spanish base at Panama.

Key topic 3: The Spanish Empire c1528–c1555

1 Pizarro and the conquest of the Incas	• Contact with the Incas (1528); the significance of the death of Huayna Capac. • The voyage of Pizarro (1530), and the significance of the war between Atahualpa and Huascar. • Key events of the Spanish conquest of Peru: the Battle of Cajamarca and the capture of Atahualpa, the revolt of the Incas, the siege of Cuzco (1536–37). The impact of the conquest.
2 Expansion of empire	• The role of the viceroys and <i>encomiendas</i> in the Spanish Empire. The role of Las Casas and the significance of the New Laws (1542). • The significance of the discovery of silver in Bolivia and in Mexico. The foundation of La Paz (1548).
3 Impact of the 'New World' on Spain	• The importance of gold and silver for the Spanish economy and to support Spain's European empire. • The impact on Spain of the slave trade and goods from the Americas. • The government of the Spanish Empire: the role of the House of Trade and Council of the Indies.